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RN: Maritime Sociology
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Militarizing a Border Island

Local Struggles Supporting and Opposing a Military Base Installation in Ishigaki Island, (Okinawa)

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Contents

1.Introduction

2.Method

3.Results

4.Discussion

5.Conclusion

1. Introduction

a border island: International Gateway or national Wall?

Ishigaki island, Okinawa
50,000 inhabitants





Why Military Base?

- In 2004-2014 Japan: “Threat of North Korea and China” and “Militarizing the 4 islands of Okinawa archipelago”
- From 2015 in Ishigaki, grass-roots movements over the military base have appeared
- Who support or protest?

Research Question

- What kind of **social networks** do local people build over the issue of military base installations, during 2015-2016?
- how about the relationship between grass-roots **movements** and local **politics**?

2. Method

How to research?



collect

data on

manifestations and
events over the issue



depict

Social networks
between actors



analysis

Who support or
protest?

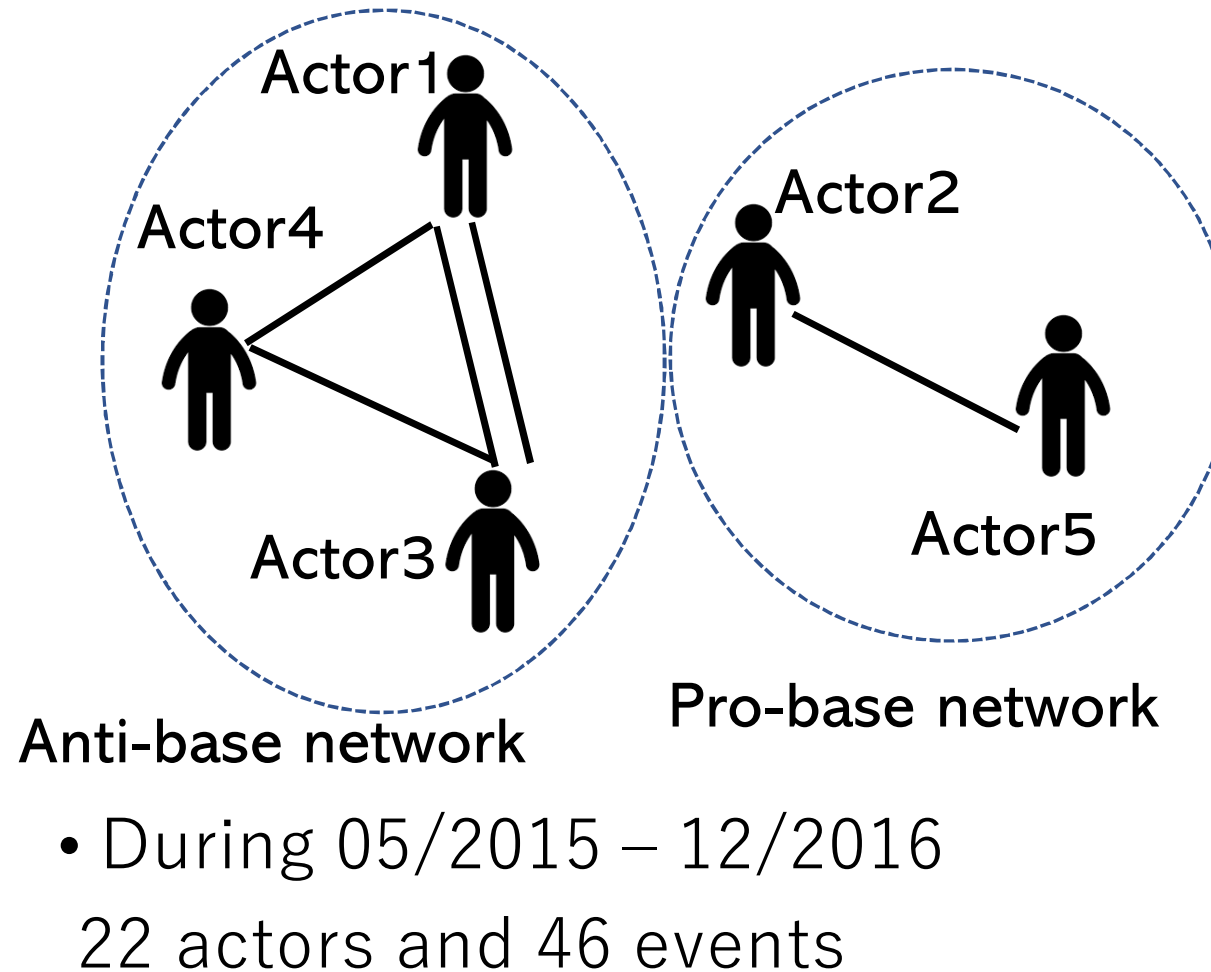


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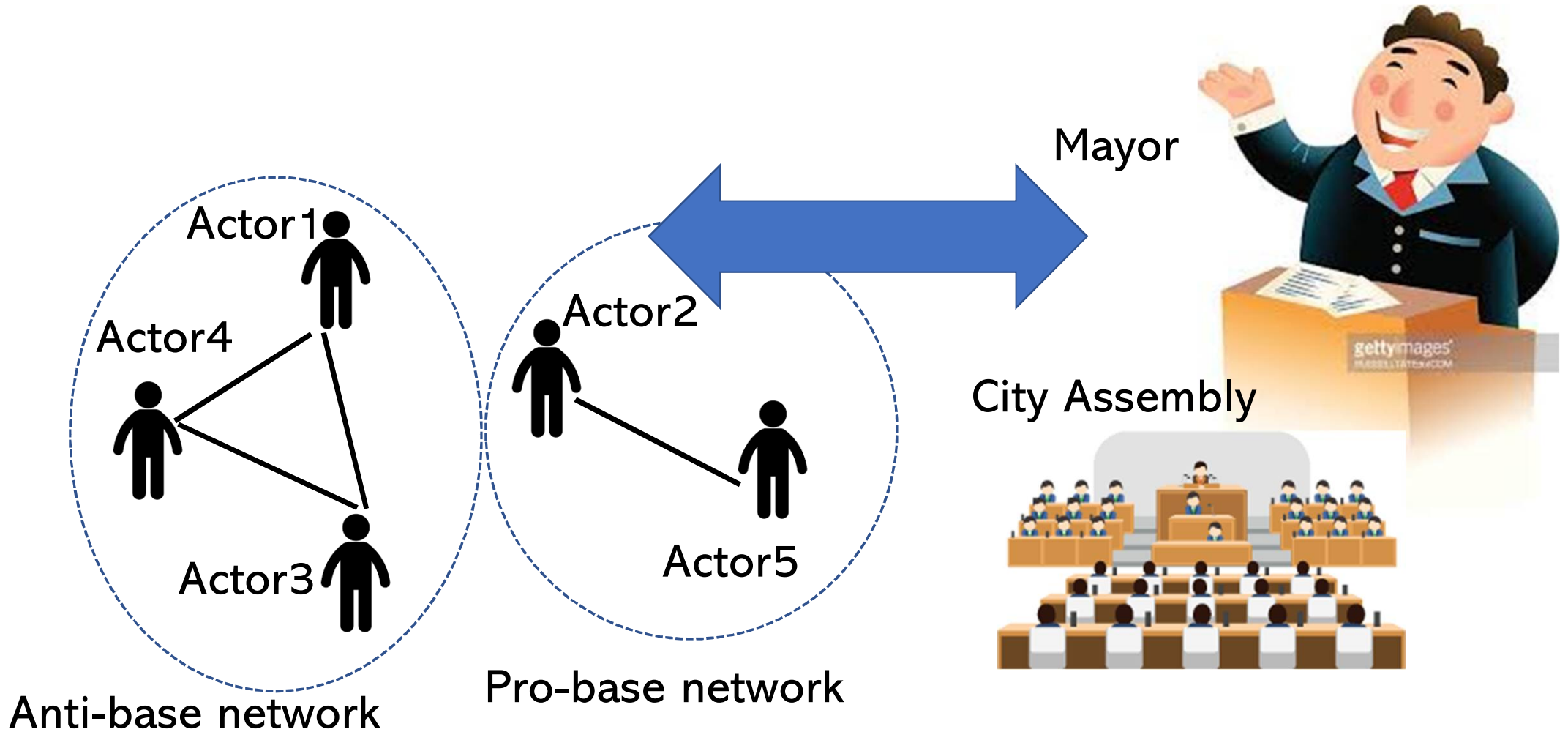


Who organize? what events?

	Event 1 Protest	Event 2 Support	Event 3 Protest
Actor 1	○	×	○
Actor 2	×	○	×
Actor 3	○	×	○
Actor 4	○	×	×
Actor 5	×	○	×
Data in local newspaper “Daily Yaeyama”			



Local Society and Politics



3. Results

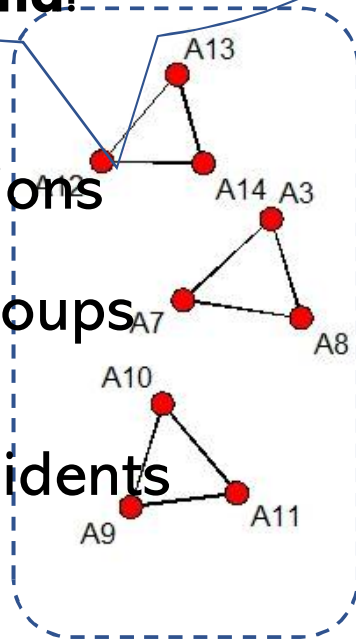
Nov 2015: Initial phase

No War! Peace!
Good Relationship!
Don't pick up our farmland!

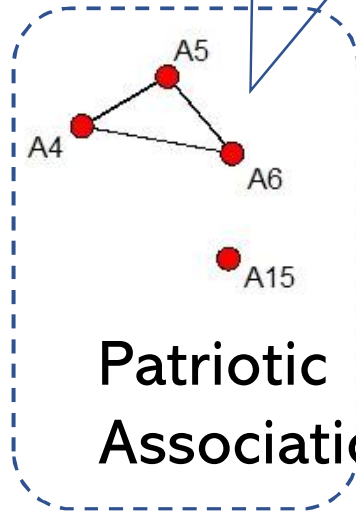
Cultural Associations

Peace groups

Local residents



National security!
Foreign Threat!



Patriotic Associations

Pro-base Network

Mayor
the right-wing

Let's listen to the citizen's voice



City Assembly (22 seats)
-15 seats: the right-wing party



Anti-base Network

Dic 2016: Mayor's Decision

No Base!
About half of local people
don't want base!
We never give up!

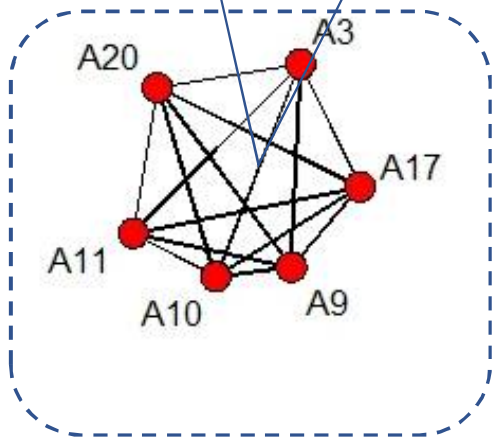
I decide to accept the
Base deployment.

Mayor

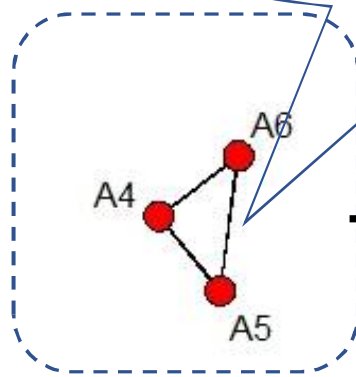


We need military base!

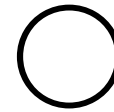
City Assembly



Anti-base



Pro-base



Findings: two gaps over the base installation

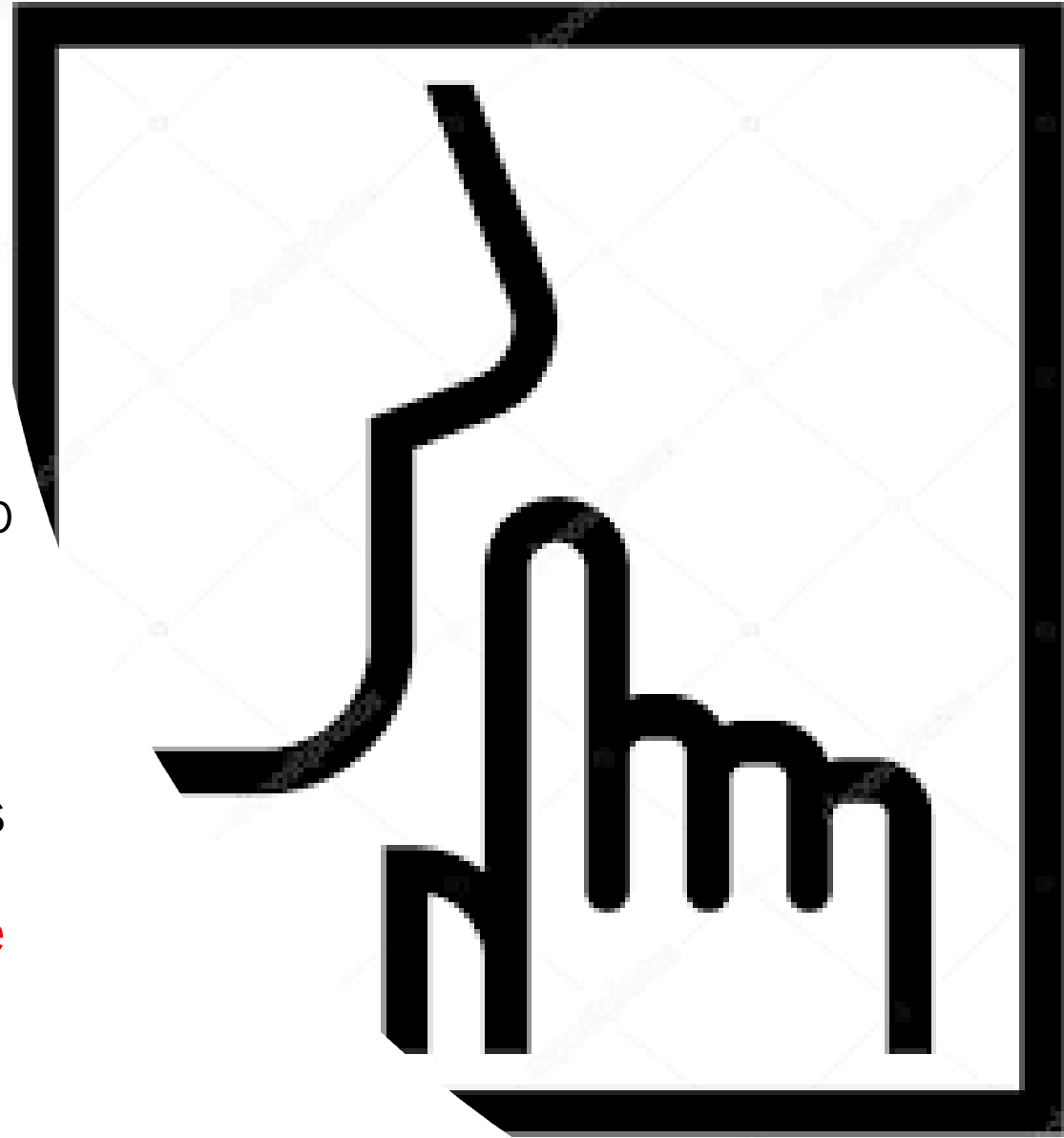
- **GAP IN SOCIETY:** pro-base and anti-base networks have emerged and **polarized**
 - a few Patriotic groups – Majority conservative politics
 - combining small citizen groups – Politically a minority
- **GAP BETWEEN SOCIETY AND POLITICS:** discrepancy between a local people's will and the political decision

4. Discussion

Why to be **silent**?

- Clientelism in isolated island
“I was born in Ishigaki and grew up here. We had have been **good relationship** with the neighboring countries. I think most of local people don't want a military base. **But** the mayor and local politicians agree with the militarization of island. So we are **afraid of revenge** if we rebel to them.”

(woman, 50years, participate to protest event)





Why continue to protest?

- Gateway story in island's history
“This island always **welcome free movements** of people, goods and foreign culture in East Asia. If the military base comes, we **predict the tragedy** may happens. Because we know catastrophe during 1944-45, only two years in the long history, when the solders appeared in this island.”

(man, 65years, representative of “No Base” association)

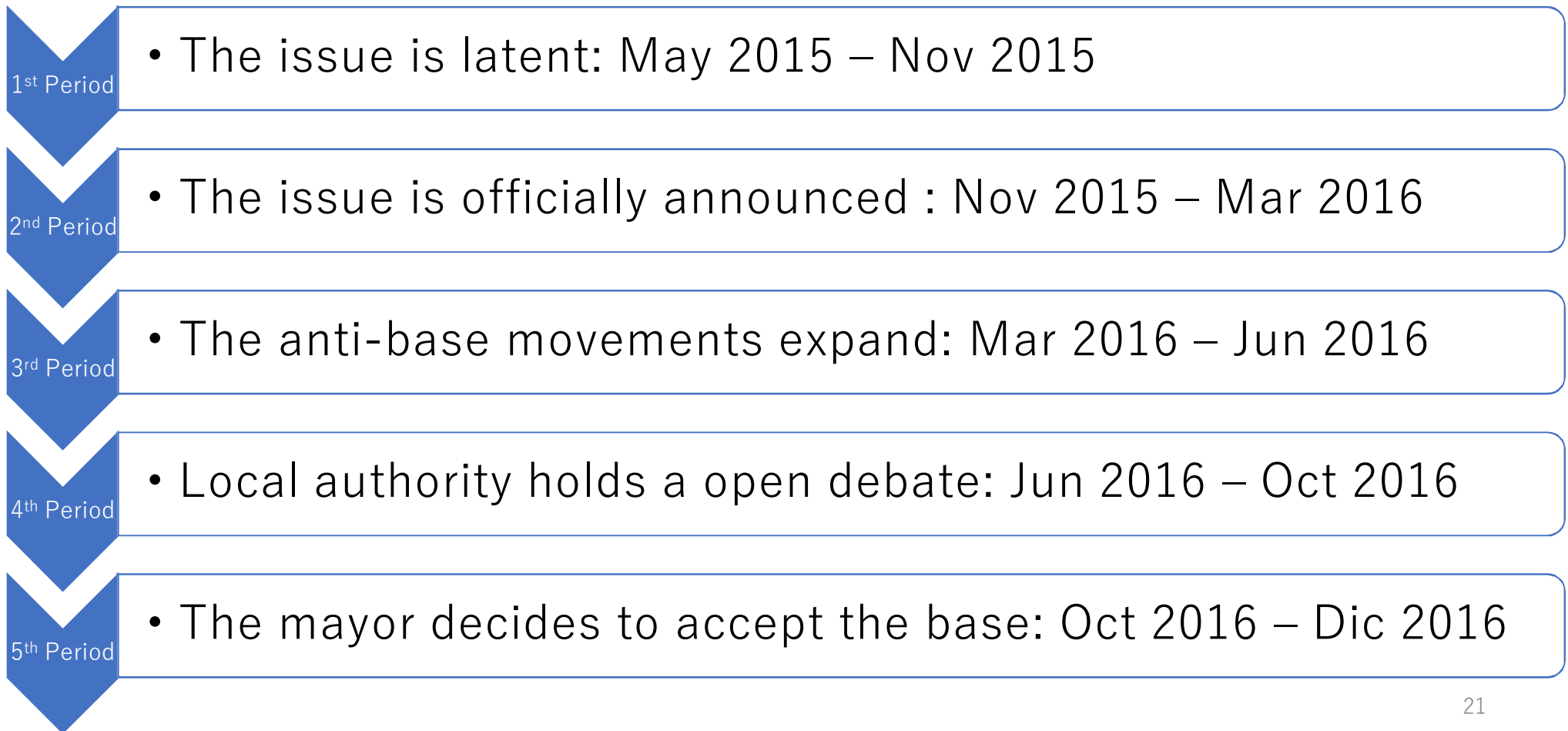
5. Conclusion

Conclusion

1. Pro-base and anti-base networks over the military base issue → gap in society
2. Political decision has priority over citizen consensus → gap between local society and politics
3. Local people in dilemma between closed personal ties and gateway culture → ambiguity of islanders

Thank you for your attention

When and what happens?



標記	
A1	平和憲法を守る八重山連絡協議会
A2	県退職教職員会八重山支部
A3	石垣島への自衛隊配備を止める住民の会
A4	八重山防衛協会
A5	自衛隊父兄会八重山支部
A6	隊友会八重山支部
A7	止めよう自衛隊配備宮古群民の会
A8	宮古島・命の水・自衛隊配備について考える会
A9	開南公民館
A10	嵩田公民館
A11	於茂登公民館
A12	森の映画社
A13	反戦自衛官と連帯する会
A14	いしがき女性9条の会
A15	八重山建設産業団体連合
A16	沖縄「うりずんの会」国会議員
A17	やいま大地会
A18	名蔵地区有志の会
A19	川原有志の会
A20	川原自治公民館
A21	自衛隊配備推進協議会 (= A4 + A5 + A6)
A22	石垣島に軍事基地をつくらせない市民連絡会 (= A3 + A1 + A9 + A10 + A11 + A17 + A20 等13 ²² 団体)

標記	Events
	March, 2015 – Dicember 2016
E1	防衛副大臣来訪への反対デモ 5/12
E2	基地配備計画撤回の特別決議採択 5/14
E3	石垣島への自衛隊基地配備を止める住民の会結成総会 8/20
E4	石垣島自衛隊配備推進協議会発足 10/26 (*11/20報道)
E5	基地配備反対街頭アピール 11/11
E6	自衛隊配備問題懇談会 11/26
E7	自衛隊基地配備を求める請願 11/26
E8	沖縄防衛局に自衛隊基地配備撤回の要望書 12/04
E9	基地配備中止を求める防衛省宛要望書 12/22
E10	地元集落、基地配備中止を求める防衛省宛抗議文 16/1/15
E11	軍事問題と自衛隊の上映集会 1/13
E12	インフラ整備等の防衛省要望 12/18 (*報道1/20)
E13	緊急集会と抗議決議文提出 1/23-27
E14	基地反対の看板設置 2/1
E15	市へ陸自配備計画撤回の要望書 3/8
E16	「人間の鎖」基地反対街頭アピール 3/10
E17	平真地域意見交換会 3/19
E18	基地配備計画撤回の防衛省宛要請決議書と署名 3/30
E19	基地配備撤回を求める「東京行動」報告会 4/9
E20	自衛隊基地建設を考える学習会 4/10
E21	憲法壊すな！安保法制＝戦争法廃止へ 4/23
E22	石垣市長への公開質問状 5/1
E23	反対特別決議の採択 5/11

E24	自衛隊基地配備に関する申し入れ 5/18
E25	説明会開催の趣旨と経緯への抗議 5/22
E26	基地配備前倒し報道に対する記者会見と抗議 5/30
E27	基地配備計画中止を求める市議会宛請願 6/6
E28	基地配備反対に関する市議会宛要請 6/9
E29	八重山防衛協会総会 8/8
E30	みんなで検討・交流会「あなたは思う？自衛隊配備」 8/23
E31	基地配備中止の市議会宛請願 8/29
E32	市長への抗議と申し入れ 9/21
E33	石垣市議会の基地配備決議への抗議集会 9/29
E34	平真地域懇談会・学習会 10/4
E35	基地配備への反対決議 10/10
E36	「市民連絡会」結成と「公聴会」見直し要請 10/12
E37	衆参国会議員へ要請・意見交換会 10/23
E38	基地配備推進にむけた勉強会 10/24
E39	陸自配備早期受け入れの要請 11/2
E40	継続議論の要請 11/25
E41	柳澤協二氏講演会 11/30
E42	市長への抗議 12/8
E43	基地配備抗議と候補地意見聴取を求める決議 12/12
E44	基地配備受入表明賛成の街頭アピール 12/27
E45	基地配備受入表明反対の街頭アピール 12/27
E46	基地配備受入表明撤回要求と抗議 12/30